

Introduction and Motivation for Master's

I would like to take this opportunity to introduce myself as Mehak Sharma an ambitious and high-achieving graduate with a Bachelor's degree in Finance and Business Economics from the University of Cincinnati, driven by a passion for financial management and analytical problem-solving. I am currently in my final semester and would complete the Bachelors program by April- 2026. The decision to pursue an MSc in Financial Markets and Investments stems from my profound interest in understanding advanced financial instruments, capital markets, and corporate decision-making, with an aim to build an impactful career in international finance. I see a Master's as crucial to deepening my expertise—particularly in areas such as valuation, portfolio management, and financial strategy—enabling me to contribute meaningfully in the global financial services sector.

Motivation for the Country and University

My motivation to study in France at Skema Business School is rooted in the school's world-class reputation for finance, corporate connections, and experiential learning focus. I am drawn to Skema's global outlook, innovative pedagogy, and access to a vibrant European business ecosystem, which aligns well with my interests in international financial markets and cross-border M&A. France's prominence as a European financial hub, together with Skema's strategic industry partnerships, offers a unique environment to engage with leading practitioners and diverse peers, crucial for developing a nuanced, international perspective.

Academic Records, Internships, and Work Experience

My academic record demonstrates consistent excellence: I have maintained a cumulative GPA of 3.97/4.00 and have been repeatedly listed on the Dean's List throughout my degree at the University of Cincinnati. My coursework till date has covered Corporate Finance, Business Analytics, Investments, Financial Modeling, M&A, and Global Business Environment, among others. Professionally, my experience spans roles such as Summer Analyst at Compass Lexecon/FTI Consulting and Investment Banking Analyst at

Two Roads Advisors. She led valuation and industry analysis for billion-dollar M&A cases, conducted econometric modeling, and contributed to financial strategy for private equity-backed transactions. Additional internships in venture capital and portfolio management at Ameriprise Financial and Andromeda Wealth Ltd. further honed my analytical and leadership skills.

Strengths, Extracurriculars, Scholarships, and Awards

My strengths include advanced quantitative analysis, financial modeling, leadership, and cross-functional teamwork, complemented by my proficiency with financial software and analytical tools. As a founding member of Women in Finance and Women in Entrepreneurship, I advanced female leadership in business careers through industry events and mentoring. I have represented my university at global case competitions—including the Harvard Global Case Competition—achieving finalist honors. My awards include the prestigious King Scholar and Kautz-Uible Scholarships, PACEsetter Distinction, and grants for international study programs in Scandinavia. My consistent recognition as a top scholar and my involvement in social impact projects underscore my holistic and driven approach.

Conclusion and Professional Contribution

In summary, I offer a blend of academic rigor, real-world financial experience, and global perspective, making me ideally suited for Skema's MSc Financial Markets & Investments and the support of an academic achievement scholarship—will empower me to fully realize my academic and career goals, enabling me to contribute not only as a future finance leader but also by enriching the Skema community with my commitment to excellence and diversity. Such an opportunity will allow me to develop skills needed to drive value in global finance and inspire the next generation—aligning with Skema's mission of leadership and impact.